

Expectation × Action: Four Ways to Live, One Steady

Defensive Pessimism — low expectation isn't giving up, and high action isn't optimism



So the question isn't "am I too pessimistic" but: repriced at today's rates, is the trade still worth it

Both variables moved, so the answer should move. Some find they are far underprepared; others find they are paying for a situation that expired.

One empirical note: forcing defensive pessimists to "relax and think positive" makes their performance worse

The anxiety isn't a fault, it's fuel. (Norem & Cantor 1986 et al.; Norem & Illingworth 1993 also tie over-rehearsal to lower long-run motivation — benefit and cost share a source)